NOTES

INTRODUCTION

xxv **Mirak howled in terror at the endless night:** H. Beveridge (trans.), *The Akbarnama of Abu-L-Fazl*, Vol. 1, Calcutta: Royal Asiatic Society, 1907, 2000 (repr.), p. 454.

xxv **'lights of joy,' we are assured, 'showed themselves in his cheeks':** Ibid.

xxv **beheld the 'lustrous forehead':** Ibid., p. 203.

xxvii **Akbar's illiteracy may have stemmed from dyslexia:** Ellen Smart, 'Akbar, Illiterate Genius', *Kalādarśana: American Studies in the Art of India*, edited by Joanna G. Williams, New Delhi: Oxford & IBH Publishing Co, 1981.

xxviii **'one observer estimated the Mughals' annual revenue at 120 million silver coins':** Richard M. Eaton, *India in the Persianate Age: 1000-1765*, London: Allen Lane, 2019, p. 371.

PART 1: THE PRINCE AND HIS REGENTS (1526–1561)

3 **dressed in silk robes and wore a high white hat:** Ruy González de Clavijo, *Narrative of the Embassy of Ruy González de Clavijo to the court of Timour, at Samarcand, A.D. 1403–6*, translated by Clements R. Markham, London: The Hakluyt Society, 1859, p. 132.

4 **for they do not consider:** Ibid., p. 139.

5 **Lord of Conjunction was a potent and sacred symbol of power:** For a detailed discussion on the subject of astrologically potent symbols, see A. Afzar Moin, *The Millennial Sovereign: Sacred Kingship and Sainthood in Islam*, New York: Columbia University Press, 2012, p. 26.

5 **'conjunction of the two superior planets':** Ibid, p. 29.

5 **'massacring a reported 80,000 inhabitants…':** Eaton, *India in the Persianate Age*, p. 104.

6 **'northern two-thirds of the subcontinent':** Ibid.

6 **'For nearly 140 years':** Wheeler M. Thackston (trans. and ed.), *The Baburnama: Memoirs of Babur, Prince and Emperor*, New York: The Modern Library, 1996, p. 100.

6 **'Mischief and devastation':** Harbans Mukhia, *The Mughals of India*, New Delhi: Blackwell Publishing, 2004, p. 3.

6 **'300 lightly armed men':** Eaton, *India in the Persianate Age*, p. 199.

6 **Like many Chinggisid khans or Timurid mirzas:** Jos Gommans, 'The Warband in the Making of Eurasian Empires', *Prince, Pen and Sword: Eurasian Perspectives*, edited by Maaike van Berkel and Jeroen Duindam, Leiden: Brill, 2018, p. 341.

7 **'the country which from old had depended on the Turk':** Annette S. Beveridge (trans.), *The Babur-nama in English (Memoirs of Babur): Translated from the original Turki text of Zahiru'd-din Muhammad Babur Padshah Ghazi*, Vol. 1, London: Luzac & Co, 1922, p. 385.

8 **'a new style of combat built around gunpowder':** Andrew de la Garza, *The Mughal Empire at War: Babur, Akbar and the Indian Military Revolution, 1500-1605*, Oxon: Routledge, 2016, p. 6.

8 **'more than a million soldiers under arms':** Ibid., pp. 10–11.